

Mustafa Kaba

CONTACT INFORMATION

Department of Economics, Koç University,
Rumelifeneri Yolu, 34450, Sarıyer / İstanbul

mkaba@ku.edu.tr

[mustafakaba.github.io](https://github.com/mustafakaba)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political Economy, Behavioral Economics, Applied Microeconomics

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Assistant Professor of Economics
Koç University, İstanbul

2024-

Post-doctoral Researcher
Max Planck Institute for Behavioral Economics, Bonn

2021-2024

Visiting Scholar
Department of Economics, UC Berkeley

Fall 2023

CONSULTANCY

Consultant, Governance Dept., World Bank, Washington D.C.

2023-2024

Data Consultant, European Bank for Reconstruction and Development
(EBRD), London

2019

EDUCATION

European University Institute (EUI), Florence
Ph.D., Economics

2016-2021

Boğaziçi University, İstanbul, Turkey
M.A., Economics

2014-2016

Boğaziçi University, İstanbul, Turkey
B.Sc., Industrial Engineering

2009-2014

WORKING PAPERS

“From Elected to Appointed: The Economic Consequences of Local Authoritarian Takeovers”
(with [Serkant Adiguzel](#) and [Murat Koyuncu](#)) [*R&R at the **Economic Journal***]

“Decisions under Narrative Complexity”
(with [Cavit Gökem Destan](#) and [Simay Küçükölbaşı](#)) [*Draft available upon request*]

“Class Voting and Economic Policy Preferences: A Machine Learning Approach”

PUBLICATIONS

“Female Leadership and Workplace Climate”, *Management Science*, 2025
(with [Sule Alan](#), [Gozde Corekcioglu](#), and [Matthias Sutter](#))

- Coverage from [IZA World of Labor](#)

- Coverage from [VoxEU](#), [CEPR](#)

“Social Norms, Political Polarization, and Vaccination Attitudes: Evidence from a Survey Experiment in Turkey”, *European Economic Review*, 2024

(with [Murat Koyuncu](#), [Sebastian Schneider](#), and [Matthias Sutter](#))

“Who Buys Vote-buying? How, how much, and at what cost?”, *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, 2022

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Decision-making under Complexity & Accountability” (with [Matthias Sutter](#) and [Zeynep Nazlı Ok](#))

“Local Responses to a Global Crisis: Public Service Delivery in Turkish Municipalities Amidst Migrant Influx”

(with [Serkant Adiguzel](#) and [Murat Koyuncu](#))

“Is Seeing Believing? How Public Service Visibility Influences Local Government Spending and Procurement Policies”

(with [Serkant Adiguzel](#), [Asli Cansunar](#) and [Murat Koyuncu](#))

“Social Identity and Policy Preferences: Evidence from a Large-scale Survey Experiment in the U.S.” (with [Matthias Sutter](#))

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

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| 2025-2027 | Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions PF-2025 (€149,000) , from the <i>EU Horizon</i> , titled “Advances in Behavioral and Experimental Economics: Role of Complexity and Narratives in Decision-Making” |
| 2025-2028 | International Fellowship for Early Stage Researchers (~€300,000) from the <i>Scientific and Technological Research Council of Türkiye (TÜBİTAK)</i> |
| 2022-2024 | Research Fellow , Center for Social and Economic Behavior (C-SEB), University of Cologne |
| 2019-2020 | PhD Scholarship , European University Institute |
| 2016-2019 | PhD Scholarship , Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs |

TEACHING

Department of Economics, Koç University:

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| Fall 2026, 2025 | ECON-451 Political Economy |
| Spring 2026, 2025 | ECON-101 Introduction to Microeconomics |

Department of Economics, University of Cologne:

- | | |
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| Spring 2024, 2022 | (Grad-level) Econometrics for Behavioral Economists |
| Fall 2023 | (Grad-level) Applied Econometrics |
- [\[Syllabus\]](#) [\[Student evaluations\]](#)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Refereeing for:

American Economic Review, Economic Journal, European Economic Review, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Labour Economics

TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

2025	Ludwig Erhard ifo Research Workshop, Fürth; Max Planck Institute, Bonn; Sabanci University, Istanbul.
2024	International Anti-Corruption Conference, Vilnius; 5 th LSE Political Economy of Turkey Workshop, London; CESifo Public Economics Conference, Munich.
2023	5 th World Bank/IFS/ODI Political Economy of Public Finances Conference, London; SAET-SWET Conference in Honor of David K. Levine, Paris; Post-doc Seminar Series at Nuffield College, Oxford; Royal Economic Society Annual Congress, Glasgow; NHH Bergen-MPI Workshop.
2022	14 th Winter Workshop in Economics at Koc University; EuroWEPS Causal Inference Workshop, EUI; Levine-Mattozzi Reading Group, EUI; Departmental Seminar at Bogazici University Economics Dept.; Brown Bag Seminar at Sabanci University Political Science Dept.
pre-2021	UC Santa Barbara-MPI Workshop; ASREC Europe; Swiss Political Science Association Annual Congress; Hertie School of Governance PhD Workshop.

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS ORGANIZED

2025	ECON Alumni Conference, European University Institute (EUI), Florence
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SKILLS

Languages: English, Turkish (native), Italian (beginner)

Programming/Typesetting: R, Python, Stata, L^AT_EX, Github, Qualtrics

REFERENCES

Prof. David K. Levine	Prof. Arthur Schram	Prof. Matthias Sutter
Department of Economics	Department of Economics	Max Planck Institute, Bonn
Royal Holloway, London	University of Amsterdam	matthias.sutter@coll.mpg.de
David.Levine@rhul.ac.uk	a.j.h.c.schram@uva.nl	

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